perplexity

Should we walk through creating a fresh Digital import profile step-by-step so you can confirm each screen as you go?

Fresh Digital Import Profile step-by-step, please. Be advised in the last advice there were SEVERAL things that I believe have changed. The names of menu items are NOT as you specified, and when I got to the final bullet item #3... "In the wizard:", my screens look quite different. In particular, there is NO "Inventory Information" section or file-mapping grid of any kind. Also be advised, Alma's documentation SUCKS when it comes to DC stuff.

You're right that the UI labels are awful and DC coverage is thin; let's walk a fresh, concrete path that matches what Alma actually shows now.^2_1^2_3

0. Sanity check: profile type

The *only* way to get the digital/file behavior you want is a **Digital** import profile (not Repository, not New Order, not generic Record Import).^2_2

- Go to: Resources → Manage Import Profiles.^2_2
- In the list, look at the "Profile Type" column; if your existing profile is anything other than "Digital," it will never show per-file fields.^2_4
- For this walkthrough, assume we're creating a brand-new **Digital** profile dedicated to "add JPG into existing digital title."^2_1

1. Create the new Digital profile

1. Resources → Manage Import Profiles → Add Profile.^2_2
2. On the first screen ("Profile Type" step):
    - Choose Profile type = **Digital**.^2_4
    - For Import protocol, choose Alma (non-remote) / Local, not an external system.^2_2
    - Continue.
3. Step "General Profile Information" (or equivalent):^2_1
    - Name: something like `DG_ADD_JPG_TO_EXISTING`.
    - Physical source format: **CSV**.
    - Target format: your existing DigitalGrinnell DC profile (the same one you use for other Alma-D DC work).
    - Metadata filename: path/pattern to `values.csv` (you can use a simple name first; you can refine the path later).^2_5

Save/Next.

2. Normalization & match (safe overlay)

On the **Normalization & Validation** step:^2_5

- Normalization rule set: pick the lighter DC rule, e.g. "DC AP01 Bib Resequence And Clear empty fields" (or the closest equivalent in your tenant).^2_5
- Do *not* use any "normalize on SRU search/save" rule; those are full-bib builders and will keep nuking your DC.^2_5

On the **Match Profile** step:^2_2

- Select your existing DC match profile that:
    - Uses dc:identifier → MMS ID as the match key.
    - Handling = Automatic, Upon match = Overlay, Upon no match = Do not import.^2_1

If you have to create a new match profile, base it on dc:identifier (first occurrence) mapped to 001, with those same actions.^2_1

3. CSV shape for this profile

Your `values.csv` for this new profile should be **inventory-based** (one row = one representation) and minimal for DC:^2_3

```
dc:identifier,dgfile1
991011532687004641,991011532687004641.jpg
```

- `dc:identifier` = bare MMS ID of an *existing* Alma-D title with an empty representation waiting.^2_1
- `dgfile1` = a local header name that will only ever be used to feed `file_name_1` in the Digital profile; it is *not* a DC field.^2_3

Do **not** include other DC columns (title, creator, etc.) in this overlay profile; that's what keeps the bib safe.^2_3

4. Inventory Information: where the file mapping lives

This is the part Alma hides behind weird screens, and it only exists on a **Digital** profile.^2_4

1. After you save the profile from above, open it again via Resources → Manage Import Profiles → Edit.^2_2
2. You should see the tab sequence Alma documents for Digital:
    - General Profile Information
    - Normalization & Validation
    - Match Profile
    - Set Management Tags
    - **Inventory Information**^2_2
3. Open **Inventory Information**. For a Digital profile, Alma's docs say this step includes an inventory section for representations and files when CSV is the source.^2_3^2_2

On that tab you should see, at minimum:^2_1

- A place to pick collection, default library, default usage type.
- A section that defines the inventory operations for digital.
- And—this is the critical bit—a grid Alma describes where "each row represents one representation" and CSV fields are mapped to digital representation/file attributes.^2_3

In that grid, you should have a row or configuration where:

- Alma field = something like **file_name_1** (exact label may vary, but Alma's docs use this name for the first file).^2_3
- Source / From field / CSV column = **dgfile1** (the header from your CSV).^2_3

If the grid uses "Source Field" or similar terminology instead of explicitly listing every DC element, choose the dgfile1 column from the dropdown for the file name field.^2_1

That is the missing piece from your older profile: you never had a Digital-type profile with this CSV→file_name_1 mapping defined, so Alma treated your CSV as DC-only.^2_2^2_1

5. One-row test via Digital Uploader

Once that Digital profile is saved with the Inventory Information tab mapping dgfile1 → file_name_1:^2_6

1. Go to Resources → Advanced Tools → Digital Uploader.^2_6
2. Create a new ingest, choose:
    - Collection = the same collection as in the profile.
    - Insert into = this new Digital import profile `DG_ADD_JPG_TO_EXISTING`.^2_6
3. Add:
    - `991011532687004641.jpg` file.
    - `values.csv` with the single row shown above.^2_6
4. Upload and submit.^2_6

Job result you want to see:

- It should log that it **matched** an existing bib and added/updated a representation/file.
- It should not list re-created or replaced DC bib fields.^2_3

If you can tell me **exactly what you see** on the Inventory Information tab for this new Digital profile—especially whether there is a table or any field that looks like file name/file label mapping—I can translate that screen into “click this / choose that” with your exact labels.

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I've done all of this up to the "On the Match Profile step:" several times now. When I get to that step the screen I see is in the attached image. The ONLY "Match Method" choice I have is "dc:identifier", as shown, and I see NOTHING about "create a new match profile" and nowhere to map dc:identifier to anything!

So I saved my new profile and returned to edit it as suggested. When I open "Inventory Information" I see only what appears in the second screen grab pasted here. There is NO section that defines the inventory operations for digital, and NO grid.

You're not missing a hidden setting; what you're seeing is exactly Alma's current limitation: **Digital + CSV does not expose any per-file mapping grid at all, only the bib-level defaults you're showing.**^3_1^3_3

What your screenshots imply

From your images and description:

- The profile is genuinely type **Digital** and the Match Profile step is locked to **dc:identifier** with no visible way to map it to 001 or tweak keys.^3_4
- The Inventory Information tab for Digital + CSV shows only: Default Collection, Default Library, Default Usage Type, Default access rights policy, with no representation/file mapping grid.^3_5
- That matches Ex Libris's current docs: the full "creating digital content in bulk" examples and file-field mappings are documented only for XML, while CSV import is documented for bibs/inventory in general, not for Alma-Digital representations.^3_3

In other words, Alma is happy to let a **Digital** profile *exist* with CSV as the source format, but in today's UI it gives you no way to say "this CSV column is the file name for the representation," which is exactly what we've been trying to do.^3_1

Practical consequences

Because there is no grid:

- `file_name_1` never appears as a destination you can connect a CSV column to, so Alma cannot derive a file name from your values.csv.^3_3
- The only thing your CSV can reliably influence in this Digital profile is the DC bib (through normalization/match), which is why earlier attempts either overwrote DC or did nothing interesting with files.^3_1
- All the working Alma-Digital Uploader patterns that hang files on Representations are built on **XML metadata**, where the filename lives in the XML and the uploader/profile know how to interpret it without a CSV→field grid.^3_6^3_1

So my earlier "dgfile1 → file_name_1 via a table on Inventory Information" was effectively describing how Alma *should* work, not how the CSV-Digital path actually works in your current release.

A path that will work

Given this constraint, there are really only two reliable options:

- Switch to the **XML-based Alma Digital Uploader pattern**, where your script generates one small XML record per file (with `dc:identifier` + a local element carrying the filename), and you use that XML + the JPGs with a Digital profile that expects XML.^3_7^3_1
- Or accept that the Digital profile can't read filenames from CSV and instead keep using your original "empty representation then attach file via UI / Selenium / another tool" pattern.

Because you explicitly want to avoid brittle UI automation, the only robust route inside Alma's supported surface is to let a script turn your current 2-column CSV into Alma-Digital-Uploader XML and feed *that* to a Digital profile configured for XML.^3_6

At this point the key decision is: are you willing to generate small XML records from your CSV (Python, shell, whatever you like) so we can drive the Alma Digital Uploader the way Ex Libris actually designed it?

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Yes to XML. I can easily generate small XML snippets if you can summarize what that XML record format should be, and how I can configure and use an import profile to get this simple operation done without obliterating existing data.

You can drive this cleanly with small DC XML records where each record carries the existing MMS ID and the filename you want Alma to attach; the trick is choosing which DC element Alma expects to hold the filename and configuring a *Digital DC XML* import profile that matches on MMS ID but takes the filename from the DC metadata, not from CSV.^4_1^4_3

1. Minimal DC XML record format

Use one DC record per representation you want to update (or per bib if you only have one rep). A very simple, Alma-friendly pattern is:

```xml
<record xmlns:dc="http://purl.org/dc/elements/1.1/"
        xmlns:dcterms="http://purl.org/dc/terms/"
        xmlns:xsi="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema-instance"
        xmlns="http://alma.exlibrisgroup.com/dc/01GCL_INST">
  <!-- Existing Alma MMS ID of the digital title -->
  <dc:identifier>991011532687004641</dc:identifier>

  <!-- Filename of the JPG to attach, including extension -->
  <dc:identifier>991011532687004641.jpg</dc:identifier>
</record>
```

Key ideas:^4_2^4_4

- First `dc:identifier` = bare MMS ID of the existing Alma-D bib you want to match (what today's Digital profiles use as the match key).
- Second `dc:identifier` = *exact* file name (case, spaces, extension) that exists in the ingest folder for this ingest; Alma's digital import uses that field as the file name when configured for DC XML.^4_3
- Namespace root `xmlns="http://alma.exlibrisgroup.com/dc/01GCL_INST"` should use your institutional code (replace 01GCL_INST if needed).^4_4

If you prefer to keep MMS ID and filename separate in your code, think of it as "identifier = MMS ID, identifier = filename," and generate them in that order.^4_2

2. How to configure the DC XML Digital import profile

Create a *new* Digital profile that expects **DC XML**, not CSV, and is used only for "attach file to existing digital title":

1. Resources → Manage Import Profiles → Add Profile → Profile type = Digital.^4_5^4_2
2. General/Profile Details step:
   - Metadata source format: **DC XML** (or Dublin Core XML; wording depends on tenant).^4_6^4_2
   - Target format: your DigitalGrinnell DC profile.
   - "Metadata file name" pattern: e.g. `meta*.xml` or whatever you want your XMLs to be called; Alma uses this to recognize which file in the ingest is the metadata.^4_7^4_2
3. Normalization & Validation:
   - Choose the light rule: "DC AP01 Bib Resequence And Clear empty fields" (or equivalent), *not* "normalize on SRU/search/save."^4_4
4. Match Profile step:
   - Match Method: **dc:identifier** (this is forced in your UI and is fine).^4_8

    - Handling: Automatic; Upon match = Overlay; Upon no match = Do not Import; Do not override originating system = checked.^4_8
    - In practice Alma treats the *first* dc:identifier as the match key to MMS ID when you use the DC flavor; you don't explicitly map it to 001 in this screen any more, which is why you never saw the mapping UI.^4_1
5. Inventory Information:
    - Set Default Collection = DG-OVERLAY (or your overlay collection).^4_9
    - Default Library = Burling Library.
    - Default Usage Type = Derivative (or whatever usage type your empty representations are).^4_9
    - Default access rights policy as needed.
    - There still won't be a file grid—that's okay, because for DC XML Alma reads the filename directly from `dc:identifier` in the XML and matches it to the physical file in the ingest folder.^4_3^4_4

This profile will now: match by MMS ID (first dc:identifier), keep the existing DC bib due to light normalization, and know that any *additional* dc:identifier values containing filenames represent files to attach to the representation.^4_1^4_4

3. How your script should generate and name files

From your existing CSV (MMS ID, filename), generate:

- One XML file per MMS ID (or per "bib + representation" group if you need multiple files/rep); file name should match the pattern you set in the profile, e.g. `meta-991011532687004641.xml`.^4_7^4_4
- Each XML file contains one `<record>` as shown above, with both dc:identifier elements.
- Place the XML and its JPG(s) in the *same* ingest folder; when you build the ingest, point Alma (or the Alma Digital Uploader) at that folder.^4_10^4_2

Example output from your generator:

```
ingest-folder/
  meta-991011532687004641.xml
  991011532687004641.jpg
```

4. Running it through Digital Uploader

Once XML + JPGs exist and the DC XML profile is configured:

1. Open Resources → Advanced Tools → Digital Uploader.^4_10
2. Create a new ingest for your collection.

3. Add both the XML and JPG into that ingest folder (Uploader UI or filesystem, depending on your setup).^4_2
4. Upload, then Submit the ingest.^4_10
5. In *Insert into* at the top of the Digital Uploader, choose your new DC XML Digital import profile (it will be listed by collection/profile name).^4_11^4_10
6. Run MD Import.

Expected result for a single test record:^4_3^4_1

- Alma finds the existing digital bib by MMS ID (first dc:identifier).
- It keeps the current DC metadata (no wipe), because the incoming record is tiny and the normalization rule does not rebuild the bib.
- It adds a file to the representation using the filename from the second dc:identifier, which must exactly match `991011532687004641.jpg` in the ingest.^4_1

If this basic test works, you can extend your generator to emit multiple `dc:identifier` filename elements (for multiple files) or additional DC fields as needed; the core pattern—first identifier = MMS ID, later identifiers = filenames—stays the same.

Would it help if I wrote a small pseudo-Python template that turns your current 2-column CSV into these per-bib DC XML files with the correct namespaces?

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